

KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

From religious division to the Armada: How did Elizabeth secure her throne?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home				
L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain				
L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88				
L4: KT2.4: The Armada				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for, and the significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569–70).
- ☐ Analyse the key features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- ☐ Evaluate the methods used by Sir Francis Walsingham and his use of spies to uncover treason.
- ☐ Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Mary, Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Treason | Excommunication

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q26. Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.

Exam Q27. Describe one feature of the Ridolfi plot.

Exam Q28. Describe one feature of the Throckmorton plot.

Exam Q29. Describe one feature of the Babington plot.

Exam Q30. Describe one feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's use of spies.

Exam Q31. Explain why the Revolt of the Northern Earls took place in 1569. Stimulus: Loss of political power / Religion

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Exam Q32. Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots, was executed in 1587. [Aligned to Spec Topic] Stimulus: The Babington Plot / Sir Francis Walsingham

[illegible]

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[illegible]

Exam Q33. 'The main reason for the failure of Catholic plots against Elizabeth was the work of Sir Francis Walsingham.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Spies / Lack of foreign support

[illegible]

Exam Q34. 'The Revolt of the Northern Earls was the most significant challenge to Elizabeth's rule in the years 1569–86.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Earl of Northumberland / Babington's execution (1586)

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex roots of the Anglo-Spanish conflict, focusing on religious, political, and commercial rivalry.
- ☐ Explain the significance of English involvement in the Netherlands, specifically the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch.
- ☐ Analyse the causes and Philip II's strategic plan for the Spanish Armada.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the Armada's catastrophic failure, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: In what year was Mary, Queen of Scots executed at Fotheringhay Castle?

2. Define: What is an 'agent provocateur'?

3. Explain: How did the 1570 Papal Bull impact Philip II's view of his duty towards Elizabeth?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about the Babington Plot.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Privateer | Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) | Galleon | Fireships

Your Sentence:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q35. Describe one feature of English privateering in the New World.

Exam Q36. Describe one feature of the religious rivalry between England and Spain.

Exam Q37. Describe one feature of Sir Francis Drake's activities in the Americas.

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This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Exam Q39. 'Commercial rivalry was the main cause of the growing tension between England and Spain in the years 1570–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Privateering / Religious differences

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain, focusing on religious shifts, the Genoese Loan, the assassination of William of Orange, and the Treaty of Joinville.
- ☐ Analyse the significance of English direct involvement in the Netherlands through the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch and the actions of Robert Dudley.
- ☐ Evaluate the strategic impact of Francis Drake's preemptive raid on Cadiz in 1587 ('Singeing the King of Spain's beard').

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Privateer**

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q40. Describe one feature of English involvement in the Netherlands, 1585–88.

Exam Q41. Describe one feature of Drake’s raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Exam Q42. Describe one feature of Robert Dudley's actions in the Netherlands.

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Exam Q44. 'Drake's raid on Cadiz was the most important reason for the delay of the Spanish Armada.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Wooden barrel staves / Financial impact on Spain

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L4: KT2.4: The Armada

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex, overlapping reasons why Philip II finally decided to launch the Spanish Armada in 1588.
- ☐ Analyse the Spanish invasion plans, highlighting the critical logistical flaws from the very beginning.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the English victory, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.
- ☐ Explain the immense domestic and international consequences of the Armada's defeat.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Armada | Fireships

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q45. Describe one feature of the Spanish invasion plans for the Armada.

Exam Q46. Describe one feature of English tactics used to defeat the Spanish Armada.

Exam Q47. Describe one feature of the Battle of Gravelines.

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[illegible]

[illegible]

Exam Q49. 'The English defeated the Spanish Armada because of superior ship design and naval tactics.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Long-range culverins / The 'Protestant Wind'

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:
